

A Peek at Three Python Databases: pickleDB, TinyDB and ZODB

Persistence of data plays a critical role in most software applications. This article introduces three databases—pickleDB, TinyDB and ZODB—which are implemented in Python. Let's explore their unique characteristics and use case scenarios.



The support for a large number of databases is one of the many features that make Python a favourite language for software developers. Apart from supporting general-purpose database systems such as MySQL, Oracle, PostgreSQL, Informix, etc, it has support for many other specific systems also. For example, it has support for embedded databases such as SQLite and ThinkSQL. And it supports graph databases such as Neo4J.

This article explores three databases -- pickleDB, TinyDB and ZODB. These three are implemented in Python and used for specific purposes.

pickleDB

pickleDB is a simple and lightweight data store. It stores the data as a key-value store. It is based on the Python module named SimpleJSON, which allows developers

to handle JSON (JavaScript Object Notation) in a simple and faster manner. SimpleJSON is a pure Python implementation with no dependencies; it functions as an encoder and decoder for Python versions 2.5+. The complete documentation on SimpleJSON is available at <https://simplejson.readthedocs.io/>.

Developed by Harrison Erd, pickleDB is available with the BSD three-clause licence. It may be installed effortlessly with the following command:

```
$ pip install pickledb
```

The name pickleDB is inspired by a Python module named pickle, which pickleDB was using earlier. Though the later versions of pickleDB started using the SimpleJSON module, the name pickle was retained.